

THE '99ERS

"The team was incredible. I'd never seen female athletes on TV in that way. Thinking about it gives me chills. I wanted to be them when I grew up."

- ALEX MORGAN

A record crowd of over 90,000 – and a record 18 million television viewers in the United States – watched Brandi Chastain secure the 1999 World Cup title for the U.S. with a dramatic penalty-kick goal against China.

Chastain immediately took off her jersey and dropped to her knees in a spontaneous celebration while wearing a Nike sports bra. The victorious image of Chastain in a prototype from Nike's InnerActives line was featured on magazine covers and newspapers worldwide. That sparked widespread interest from fans wanting to buy "Brandi's bra" and became a monumental moment in the evolution of Nike's sports bras.

The emotional victory by the '99ers inspired many young girls, including a 10-year-old Alex Morgan who grew up to be a key member of the 2019 U.S. World Cup team. Nike used the kit worn by the '99ers as inspiration when designing the 2019 home kit for the U.S.

Twenty years later, the 1999 World Cup win at the Rose Bowl remains an iconic moment that spiked global football's popularity among women in the U.S. The '99ers, led by Nike athlete Mia Hamm, are also celebrated as the team that showed what it *really* meant to "play like a girl."

QUICK FACTS:

- The 1999 World Cup final's official attendance of 90,185 in Pasadena, California, included U.S. President Bill Clinton. To date, it is the most fans to ever attend a women's sports event in the world.
- After a scoreless regulation and overtime, the U.S. beat China 5-4 on penalty kicks. A save by U.S. goalkeeper Briana Scurry on China's third PK attempt set up Chastain's heroic goal.

DISCUSS:

- What's your favorite World Cup memory?
- How has women's sport changed in your lifetime?









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